

Introducing Maya Chen

Personal Introduction My name is Maya Chen and I am a 27-year-old backend engineer based in Toronto, Canada. I was born in Vancouver and moved to Toronto in 2019 to pursue my career in software engineering. I am passionate about distributed systems and enjoy mentoring junior engineers in my free time.

Education I graduated from the University of Waterloo in 2021 with a Bachelor of Computer Science degree, specializing in software engineering. During my studies, I completed two co-op terms at a logistics startup, where I first became interested in backend infrastructure. I also completed a minor in applied mathematics.

Work Experience I currently work as a Senior Backend Engineer at Northwind Analytics, a data infrastructure company, where I have been employed since 2022. Before that, I worked for two years as a Software Engineer at Bluefin Logistics, building routing algorithms for delivery trucks. My first job out of university was as a Junior Developer at a small fintech company called Ledgerly, where I worked on payment reconciliation systems.

Projects Throughout my career I have built several notable projects. The first is called RiverStream, a real-time event processing pipeline built with Kafka and Flink that processes over ten million events per day. The second project is named CoralCache, a distributed caching layer written in Go that reduced database load by sixty percent at Northwind Analytics. The third project is TidalMap, an open source geospatial routing library that I maintain in my spare time, used by several small logistics companies.

Skills My technical skills include Python, Go, and Java for backend development. I am experienced with PostgreSQL, Redis, and Cassandra for data storage. For infrastructure, I regularly use Docker, Kubernetes, and Terraform. I am also comfortable with Kafka, RabbitMQ, and gRPC for building distributed systems.

Hobbies Outside of work, I enjoy rock climbing, playing the violin, and baking sourdough bread. I also volunteer on weekends teaching coding basics to high school students at a local community center. In the winter, I go snowboarding with friends whenever I get the chance.